

OpenVAS / GVM Installation Troubleshooting & Fix Report

System: Kali Linux

Tool: Greenbone Vulnerability Manager (GVM 25.04.0) / OpenVAS

Overview

The installation and setup of OpenVAS (now known as GVM) required resolving several critical issues involving PostgreSQL collation mismatches, missing database schemas, and user creation errors. Below is a complete list of problems encountered and their resolutions.

Issue-by-Issue Breakdown

Issue: Missing gvmd PostgreSQL Database

Symptom:

ERROR: The Postgresql DB does not exist.

FIX: Run 'sudo runuser -u postgres -- /usr/share/gvm/create-postgresql-database'

Root Cause:

The required gvmd database wasn't created due to PostgreSQL collation version mismatch.

Fix:

Refresh the collation version for the postgres and template1 databases.

Commands Used:

Refresh collation for postgres

```
sudo -u postgres psql -c "ALTER DATABASE postgres REFRESH COLLATION VERSION;"
```

Refresh collation for template1 (used to create new DBs)

```
sudo -u postgres psql -c "ALTER DATABASE template1 REFRESH COLLATION VERSION;"
```

Then, re-run the database creation script:

```
sudo runuser -u postgres -- /usr/share/gvm/create-postgresql-database
```

 **Result:** Database, roles, and extensions (uuid-oss, pgcrypto, pg-gvm) created successfully.

2 Issue: PostgreSQL Collation Version Mismatch

Symptom:

WARNING: database "postgres" has a collation version mismatch

DETAIL: version 2.40 used, 2.41 provided

Root Cause:

System libraries were updated but PostgreSQL databases were using an older collation version.

Fix:

Refreshed collation version as per PostgreSQL's hint.

Commands Used:

```
sudo -u postgres psql -c "ALTER DATABASE postgres REFRESH COLLATION VERSION;"
```

```
sudo -u postgres psql -c "ALTER DATABASE template1 REFRESH COLLATION VERSION;"
```

✅ **Result:** Mismatch resolved.

3 Issue: No GVM Login User Found

Symptom:

ERROR: No users found. You need to create at least one user to log in.

Fix:

Created a new GVM user with a password.

Command Used:

```
sudo runuser -u _gvm -- gvmc --create-user=admin --password='YourStrongPassword123'
```

✅ **Result:** Admin user created successfully.

4 Issue: GVM Not Ready After Installation

Command Used to Verify:

```
sudo gvm-check-setup
```

Errors Resolved During the Setup:

- ✅ Redis configuration checked
- ✅ Notus and NVTs fully installed

-  PostgreSQL DB created
-  GVM Manager and Scanner functional
-  Extensions installed and permissions applied
-  Certificates validated

 **Final Status:** All checks passed except for login user (now resolved).

Conclusion

After addressing:

- Collation mismatches in PostgreSQL,
- Missing gvmd database and roles,
- And creating the required GVM user,

 **The OpenVAS / GVM setup is now fully functional and ready for use.**
